Chapter-wise Detailed Notes — Directive Principles of State Policy

Indian Government & Politics · Unit 1 · Chapter Directive Principles of State Policy

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Chapter Study Notes

Learning focus

Directive Principles are contained in Part IV, Articles 36–51. They guide the state in making laws and policies toward social and economic welfare.

1. Article 37 states that the principles are not enforceable by courts but are fundamental in the governance of the country.

2. They address matters such as welfare, livelihood, equal pay, public health, education, village panchayats, environmental protection and international peace.

3. Fundamental Rights and Directive Principles have different legal status but are often interpreted as complementary constitutional objectives.

4. Their practical implementation depends on legislation, public resources, political priorities and accountability.

Revision checklist

■ Can I define the key concept in my own words?

■ Can I explain its main features and distinguish it from related concepts?

■ Can I support an argument with a relevant example, thinker or constitutional provision?

■ Can I discuss at least one limitation or counterargument?